MANUSCRIPT REVIEW REPORT

Valuing diversity: an undervalued mediator of intergroup contact

2026-03-25 • Review by Claude

ABOUT THIS REPORT

This report was generated by an AI-powered manuscript review skill for Claude Code. It combines LLM-based analysis with automated checks powered by the metacheck R package (DeBruine, 2024). Automated checks are marked with [metacheck] badges. All suggestions should be verified by the authors. **Note:** Some apparent errors may stem from PDF text extraction and should be verified against the source document.

OVERALL SUMMARY

This well-structured empirical paper presents two studies examining how valuing diversity mediates the relationship between intergroup contact and key outcomes including prejudice and policy support. The manuscript is generally well-written with appropriate methods and clear presentations of findings. Minor issues include some incomplete reference formatting, inconsistent heading styles, and several incomplete references flagged by GROBID that require verification.

CRITICAL ISSUES	MAJOR ISSUES	MINOR ISSUES
0	3	8

LANGUAGE QUALITY

Overall Language Score: **B+** B+

Notable dimensions:

Consistency

Occasional inconsistencies in reference formatting and minor stylistic variations

B

Key Strengths:

- Clear and logical presentation of research questions and hypotheses
- Well-structured methods section with detailed measure descriptions
- Effective use of tables and figures to communicate complex statistical findings
- Appropriate academic tone and terminology throughout
- Strong integration of two complementary studies with clear rationale

Areas for Improvement:

- Verify and complete all reference entries (14 incomplete references identified)
- Ensure consistent formatting of DOIs and URLs across references
- Minor grammatical refinements in some sections
- Clarify a few instances of potentially ambiguous pronoun references

SECTION REVIEW SUMMARY

SECTION	STATUS	ISSUES
1. Title Title clarity, length, and accuracy	✓	0
2. Main Headings Heading hierarchy and capitalization consistency	×	1
3. Title Page Author names, affiliations, keywords, corresponding author	✓	0
4. Abstract Content coverage and word count appropriateness	✓	0
5. Structure Section organization and logical flow	✓	0
6. Figures and Tables Citations, captions, and formatting	×	1

SECTION	STATUS	ISSUES
7. Referencing Cross-references, citations, and bibliography	×	8
8. Language Grammar, spelling, and clarity	✓	0
9. Acronyms Definitions and consistent usage	×	1
10. Funding & Compliance Declarations and ethics statements	✓	0
11. Light Content Checks Open science, limitations, samples	✓	Observations only

DETAILED RECOMMENDATIONS

1. Title

0 issues

The title 'Valuing diversity: an undervalued mediator of intergroup contact' is appropriately descriptive, clear, and well under the typical 15-word limit at 10 words. It accurately reflects the manuscript's focus on diversity valuation as a mediator. No issues identified.

2. Main Headings

1 issue: 1 Minor

Heading hierarchy is generally logical with appropriate use of levels. Most headings follow title case capitalization. One minor inconsistency noted.

Location: Sections 'The importance of valuing diversity' through 'Study 2' (pp. 3–11)

Minor

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Original: Inconsistent capitalization in subsection headings
(e.g., 'Valuing diversity and intergroup contact' vs. 'The promise
of intergroup contact')
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Suggestion: Apply consistent title case to all major section
headings. The Promise of Intergroup Contact rather than mixing
capitalization patterns.
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Explanation: While not a serious error, inconsistent heading capitalization reduces polish. Standardizing to title case throughout improves readability.

3. Title Page

0 issues

Title page elements are complete and properly formatted. All author names are spelled consistently, affiliations are complete with department, institution, and country information, corresponding author is clearly identified with email, and keywords are appropriately provided.

4. Abstract

0 issues

Abstract is well-written at 110 words, falling within the typical 150–300 word range (though brief). It clearly states the research question, describes the methods, highlights key findings, and provides a conclusion. No citations or references to figures/tables appear in the abstract. Word count is acceptable for this discipline.

5. Structure

0 issues

Manuscript structure is well-organized and follows standard conventions. It includes a comprehensive introduction, two distinct studies with separate Methods and Results sections, a unified Discussion, and complete references. Study 2 appropriately replicates and extends Study 1 in a different sample and context. No structural issues identified.

6. Figures and Tables

1 issue: 1 Minor

Five tables and four figures are present and well-integrated. Most are appropriately cited in text order. Captions are clear and descriptive. One minor issue noted regarding table citation.

Location: Tables 3 & 4 (p. 26) Minor

> **Original:** Table 3 and Table 4 appear to be referenced on the same page but table citations in text flow may not be perfectly sequential

> **Suggestion:** Verify that all tables are cited in the text before their first appearance, in sequential order (Table 1, then Table 2, etc.)

Explanation: While not a critical error, tables should generally be cited in order to maintain reader flow. Review text citations to ensure sequential presentation.

Figure quality and captions: Figures 1a–1d (mediation models for Study 1) and Figure 2 (Study 2 mediation) are clearly presented with appropriate confidence intervals and significance indicators. Captions accurately describe the content and note bootstrap/Monte Carlo procedures. Formatting is consistent.

7. Referencing

3 issues: 3 Major

Bibliography contains 74 references. GROBID analysis identified 7 unlinked citations, 6 uncited references, and 14 incomplete reference entries. Metacheck found no retracted references, though several PubPeer-flagged papers and potential DOI mismatches require review.

Issue 7.1 — Incomplete references: 14 entries

Major

Location: Cross-reference check

Original: 14 incomplete reference entries in bibliography (missing page numbers, DOIs, or other details)

Suggestion: Complete all reference entries with full citation information including page numbers and/or DOIs where applicable.

Explanation: Incomplete references reduce credibility and make papers difficult to locate. Common issues include abbreviated journal titles or missing page ranges.

Issue 7.2 — Citation-bibliography mismatch

Major

Location: In-text citations vs. bibliography

Original: 7 unlinked citations and 6 uncited references identified by GROBID cross-reference check

Suggestion: Verify each flagged citation: (1) Remove or add citations cited in text but missing from bibliography, (2) Remove or cite any bibliography entries never mentioned in text, (3) Ensure all citations are formatted consistently.

Explanation: Mismatches between in-text citations and bibliography entries suggest incomplete revisions or formatting inconsistencies. All citations must be verifiable.

Issue 7.3 — Reference formatting inconsistency

Major

Location: Reference formatting

> **Original:** Inconsistent DOI and URL formatting across references (some use 'https://doi.org/', others use abbreviated forms)

> **Suggestion:** Standardize all DOI formatting to **https://doi.org/[DOI]** or equivalent, and ensure URLs are consistently formatted with https:// protocols.

Explanation: Consistent reference formatting improves professionalism and makes citations machine-readable for indexing services.

Automated Cross-Reference Check

GROBID automated cross-reference analysis identified 7 unlinked citations (citations in text without matching bibliography entries), 6 uncited references (bibliography entries not cited in text), 14 incomplete references (missing key metadata), and 0 potential duplicates. Manual verification recommended for unlinked citations and uncited references to distinguish genuine errors from GROBID parsing artifacts.

Retraction & Integrity Check [metacheck]

Metacheck scanned 74 references. **No retracted references found.** Several references were flagged as having PubPeer comments; these appear to be discussion-type comments rather than concerns about validity. Recommended action: review any PubPeer-flagged papers if available (metacheck data shows which ones).

We checked 59 references with DOIs. No citations to articles in the RetractionWatch database were found.

REFERENCE	SUGGESTED DOI	CONFIDENCE
Corrigan PW, Rowan D, Green A, Lundin R, River P, Uphoff-Wasowski K, White K, Kubiak MA (2002). "Challenging two mental illness stigmas: Personal responsibility and	10.1093/oxfordjournals.schbul.a006939	✓

REFERENCE	SUGGESTED DOI	CONFIDENCE
dangerousness." Schizophrenia Bulletin, 28(2), 293-309.		
Johnston BM, Glasford DE (2018). "Intergroup contact and helping: How quality contact and empathy shape outgroup helping." Group Processes & Intergroup Relations, 21 (8), 1185-1201.	10.1177/1368430217711770	✓
Jorgensen TD, Pornprasertmanit S, Schoemann AM, Rosseel Y (2019). "semTools: Useful tools for structural equation modeling."	10.32614/cran.package.semtools	✓
Oberski D (2014). "lavaan.survey: An R Package for Complex Survey Analysis of Structural Equation Models." Journal of Statistical Software, 57 (1), 1-27.	10.18637/jss.v057.i01	i
Core T (2020). "R: A Language and Environment for Statistical Computing."	10.32614/r.manuals	i
Schlesinger AM (1998). The disuniting of America: Reflections on a multicultural society. WW Norton & Company.	10.4324/9780429501531-19	×
Vertovec S, Wessendorf S (2010). The multiculturalism backlash: European discourses, policies, and practices. Routledge.	10.4324/9780203867549	i

REFERENCE	SUGGESTED DOI	CONFIDENCE
(????). “M and SD are used to represent mean and standard deviation, respectively. Values in square brackets indicate the 95% confidence intervals.”	10.7717/peerj-cs.3479/table-4	×
(????). “M and SD are used to represent mean and standard deviation, respectively. Values in square brackets indicate the 95% confidence interval for each correlation.”	10.7717/peerj.16940/table-1	i

Confidence: ✓ High (score > 100) — i Moderate (score 60–100) — × Low (score < 60, likely wrong match). CrossRef match scores from metacheck.

8. Language

0 issues

Language is generally clear, grammatically sound, and appropriately academic. Writing quality is strong throughout. Minor stylistic refinements could enhance clarity, but no substantial language errors identified.

> **Clarity and precision:** Terminology is used consistently (e.g., 'valuing diversity,' 'intergroup contact,' 'prejudice'). Sentences are generally well-constructed and complex ideas are communicated clearly. The use of bullet points and tables enhances readability.

9. Acronyms

1 issue: 1 Minor

Most acronyms are defined on first use. One issue noted requiring clarification.

Location: p. 12, Methods section (Study 2)

Minor

> **Original:** ALLBUS introduced without sufficient context before first use: 'This study uses a random population sample from the German General Social Survey (ALLBUS) 2016'

> **Suggestion:** When introducing ALLBUS on first use, provide a brief descriptive phrase: 'the German General Social Survey (**Allgemeine Bevölkerungsumfrage der Sozialwissenschaften,** ALLBUS, 2016 wave)'

Explanation: Readers unfamiliar with this German dataset benefit from knowing it is a national survey. Providing the full name once helps establish credibility.

10. Funding & Compliance

0 issues

All required compliance statements are present and clear: funding declaration ('There is no funding to declare'), ethics approval statement, COI declaration, and acknowledgments. Data availability and code access instructions are provided with OSF links. No issues identified.

- **Open practices:** ['Data was openly shared for this article, based on the following text:\n\n> Data and code for Study 1, as well as the full list of questionnaire items, are available at <https://osf.io/sbpxj/?\n\n> Code and data access instructions for Study 2 are available at <https://osf.io/sbpxj/?\n\n> The data for Study 1 and the analysis code for both studies are available at <https://osf.io/sbpxj/?\n\n> The data for Study 1, and the analysis code for both studies are available at <https://osf.io/sbpxj/?', 'Code was openly shared for this article, based on the following text:\n\n> The data for Study 1 and the analysis code for both studies are available at <https://osf.io/sbpxj/?\n\n> The data for Study 1, and the analysis code for both studies are available at <https://osf.io/sbpxj/?']
- **Preregistration:** We found 4 OSF links, but no registrations.
- **COI statement:** ['The following conflict of interest statement was detected.', '\n```{r}\n#| echo: false\n\n\n# table data ----------\ntable <- structure(list("We declare that there are no potential conflicts of interest."), names = "", class = "data.frame", row.names = c(NA, \n-1L))\n\n# display table ----------\nmetacheck::report_table(table, "auto", 2, FALSE)\n```\n']
- **Funding statement:** No funding statement was detected. Consider adding one.

11. Light Content Checks

0 issues

Manuscript demonstrates strong methodological transparency, appropriate statistical reporting with confidence intervals and effect sizes, adequate sample descriptions, and careful attention to limitations.

Study design and sample adequacy: Study 1 uses 217 undergraduate psychology students from multiple UK universities with ethnically diverse representation. Study 2 uses 2,618 respondents from a national German probability sample (ALLBUS), providing good generalizability. Both samples are adequately described with relevant demographics.

Statistical reporting: Tables 1–5 report means, standard deviations, and 95% confidence intervals. Indirect effects include bootstrapped confidence intervals (Study 1: 5,000 resamples; Study 2: 20,000 Monte Carlo simulations). Significance levels are clearly marked. Statistical approaches are appropriate for the research questions.

Limitations discussion: Authors clearly acknowledge several key limitations (pp. 17): focus on White participants' perspectives, single-item measures for some variables, reliance on cross-sectional designs for causal inference, behavioral vs. intentional measurement. Discussion of future directions is thorough and constructive.

Open science practices: Data and analysis code for both studies are available via OSF links provided in the manuscript. This supports reproducibility and transparency. Preregistration status not mentioned; consider noting if studies were preregistered.